

इस हाशिए
में केवल
प्रश्न संख्या
लिखें।

Only write
question
number in
this margin

Specimen Booklet

For Practice Purpose Only

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Candidate must adhere to the word limit specified in the question.
Any page or portion of the page left blank must be clearly struck off.

उम्मीदवारों को
इस हाशिए में
नहीं लिखना
चाहिए।

Candidates
must not
write on
this margin.

Q-11 The demand for smaller states reflects both democratic aspirations and administrative desperation. Critically examine this statement in light of India's federal structure, regional inequalities and cultural diversity.

Ans. The demand for smaller states represent democratic aspirations - better representation, political inclusion, recognition of their regional and ascriptive identity. It also represents administrative desperation - inefficient or too large state structure, unresponsive to local needs, unequal resource distribution. India has a unique model of federalism with rich cultural diversity but at the same time wide regional disparities.

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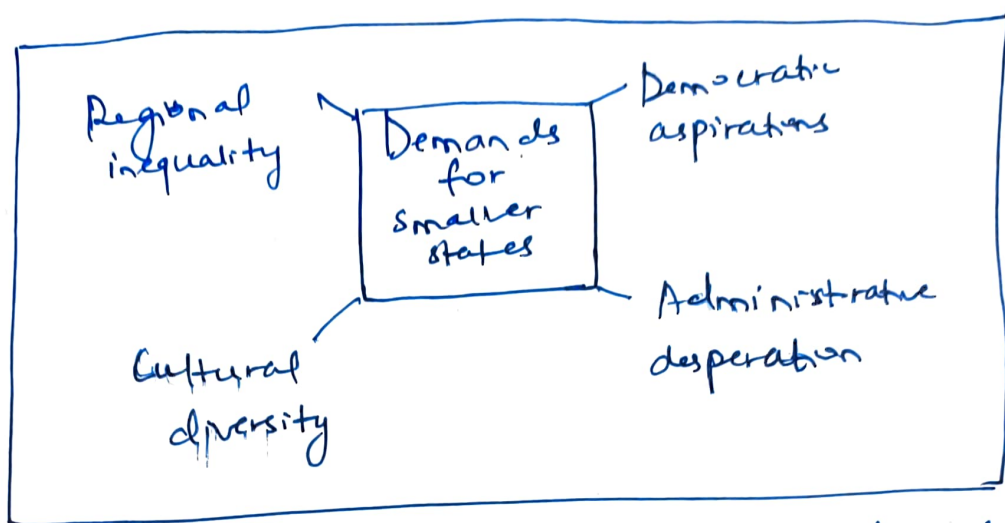


fig.: drivers behind smaller states demand

Critically examine : Federal Structure

① Flexible federalism —

Unlike USA, Indian states can be reorganised without their consent
e.g., Telangana (2014) was created despite opposition from Andhra Pradesh, Ladakh was given status of Union Territory

② ~~Dynamic~~

② Dynamic federalism —

Reorganisation of states helped India to accommodate diversity while maintaining unity.

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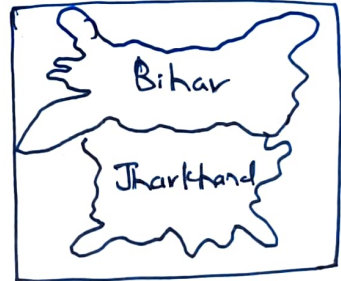
e.g., states Reorganisation Act, 1956
divided states on linguistic basis

Critically examine : Regional Inequalities

① Neglect of Backward regions —

Many ^{regions} ~~states~~ demand statehood to
address marginalisation and
uneven development. Smaller states
ensure infrastructure prioritization.

e.g., Jharkhand separated
from Bihar



② Better governance —

Smaller states allow granular - policy making, quicker implementation and
tailored developmental models.

e.g., Uttarakhand's hill areas

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Critically examine : Cultural diversity

① Protection of ethnic and linguistic identity -

Statehood protects the linguistic, ethnic and tribal identities.

eg., Nagaland, Manipur

The demand often arises to protect their identity from homogenisation.

② Participatory Democracy -

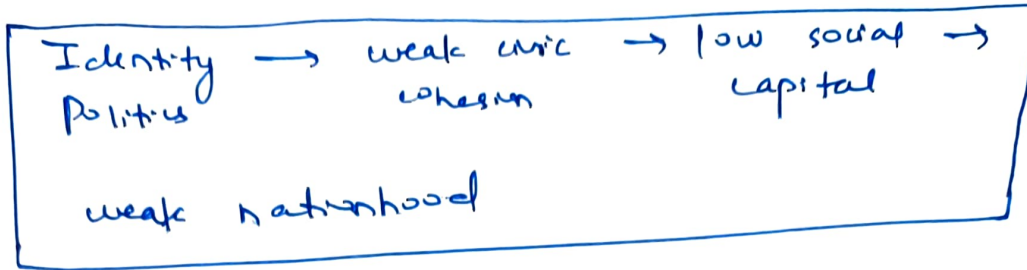
Smaller states allow greater political participation of minorities giving them voice in decision-making.

eg., representation of tribals in local self government.

③ Identity Politics -

Sometimes, these demands may lead to exclusionary principles, weakening the civic cohesion.

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Challenges of smaller states —

① Administrative Proliferation —

New states require new administrative machinery increasing the cost of governance.

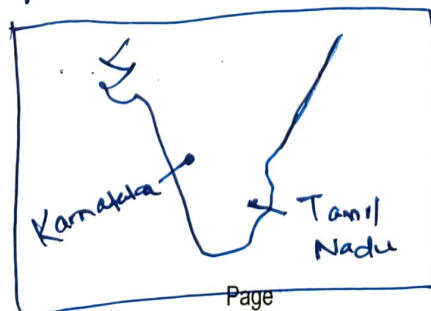
② Political Balkanisation —

Constant division can weaken national unity and create sub-nationalism.

③ Resource disputes —

Division leads to conflict over water, minerals etc

eg., Cauvery water dispute b/w
~~Andhra Pradesh~~ & Karnataka & Tamil Nadu



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④ Political Opportunism —

It may lead to political exploitation and political manipulation

⑤ Economic Disequilibrium —

Smaller states become reliant on federal fiscal transfers perpetuating developmental lag

WAY FORWARD —

① Create New State Reorganisation Commission to evaluate statehood demands

② Establish Regional Development Councils for transitional autonomy as it addresses regional demand while maintaining national unity.

③ Promote cooperative federalism as it fosters regional inclusivity without creating new states.

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- ④ Protect regional identity to foster cultural harmony without compromising national unity.
- ⑤ Empower grassroots institutions — PRIs and ULBs to address local grievances in align with Mahatma Gandhi's idea of decentralisation.